or to have God, and then judges whatever he finds in Hinduism from that exclusive standpoint.

This is not all. He carried his prejudices further into the realm of Indian philosophy itself. "In India, except in the purely popular cults, religion is never divorced from philosophy" (p. 167). One would like to know what ideas he has of philosophy, and what philosophy the forty million illiterates in India could have had for centuries to divorce it from their religion? In the strict sense, neither philosophy nor religion could ever be involved with each other except accidentally. Still, even if a religion were to be essentially involved with philosophy as Zaehner charges Hinduism to be, it is far better that it be so than that it be involved with revelation as Zaehner wrongly wants it to be.

As an instance of religion being involved with philosophy, Zaehner says that "no religion can wholly satisfy which is based fundamentally on the total rejection of the phenomenal world either as an illusion or as a prison in which the immortal spirit is held helplessly captive" (p. 168). Quite a few observations can be made on the above. First, it is absolutely wrong to say that Hindu philosophy or religion recommends a total rejection of the phenomenal world either as an illusion or as a prison in which the immortal is helplessly held! What both philosophy and religion recommend in India is the non-finality of the changing world as we perceive and experience it. The progress to transcendence in both Hindu philosophy and religion is through the fulfillment of the phenomenality of the world itself. There is not, nor can there be, any skipping over the phenomenal world. Secondly, the illusoriness of the world or its rejection as a philosophy is, after all, held by only one school of philosophy. It may be wrong, and its opposite, namely, the final or absolute reality of the phenomenal world may be the correct school of philosophy. But for Zaehner both should be irrelevant, because religion is not to be involved with philosophy at all, either right or wrong.

But more importantly, in Hinduism the immortal spirit is not at all held helplessly captive, because the entire purpose of Hinduism as a religion is the *release* of man from captivity, i.e., the "hopefulness" of the escape from captivity. Zaehner conveniently forgets that, speaking of God in the Upaniṣads, he himself contradicts this earlier statement when he says "Why does God imprison man in matter, only to *release* him at his appointed time?" (p. 115).[3] How is the above consistent with the immortal spirit in Hinduism being held "helplessly captive"? This is how Zaehner by the injection of a single word, "helplessly," distorts the whole philosophy and